

**No. R-261. House concurrent resolution celebrating the essential contributions of Irish American patriots in the struggle for our nation's independence.**

(H.C.R.214)

Offered by Representatives Casey of Montpelier, Burke of Brattleboro, Galfetti of Barre Town, Greer of Bennington, Nugent of South Burlington, Ode of Burlington, Priestley of Bradford, Sweeney of Shelburne, and Waszazak of Barre City

*Whereas*, on March 17, 1776, the British ended an 11-month-long siege of Boston, Massachusetts, leaving control of the city to American forces, including General John Sullivan, the son of Irish immigrants, who General George Washington named his Officer of the Day, and who subsequently served in New Hampshire as governor and as a federal district court judge, and his brother, James Sullivan, later served in Massachusetts as an associate state supreme court justice, attorney general, and, ultimately, as governor, and

*Whereas*, eight signers of the Declaration of Independence were Irish Americans, either born in Ireland or in the colonies, namely, Thomas McKean, who would later serve as President of the Continental Congress; Charles Carroll; James Smith; George Taylor; Matthew Thorton; Edward Rutledge; Thomas Lynch Jr.; and George Read, and

*Whereas*, these eight illustrious individuals' spirit of independence was crucial in the establishment of the American nation, and, generations later, their legacy helped inspire the founding of the Irish Republic, and both constituted new societies for free individuals, and

*Whereas*, John Dunlap, who emigrated from County Tyrone, printed the first copies of the Declaration of Independence, and the first international newspaper publication of the Declaration occurred in August 1776 in Ireland, on the front page of the *Belfast News Letter*, and

*Whereas*, 250 years ago, Stephen Moylan, George Washington's Irish American aide-de-camp, in a letter he wrote, first used the phrase "United States of America" on paper, and

*Whereas*, in a concise summary of Irish Americans' role in securing American independence, Lord Mountjoy declared to the British Parliament in London that "America was lost by Irish emigrants ... I am assured from the best authority, the major part of the American Army was composed of Irish and that the Irish language was as commonly spoken in American ranks as English. I am also informed it was their valor that determined the contest," and

*Whereas*, on Saint Patrick's Day 2026, the year marking our nation's 250th birthday, it is most fitting to commend the role of Irish Americans in ensuring the success of the American Revolution, *now therefore be it*

***Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives:***

That the General Assembly celebrates the essential contributions of Irish American patriots in the struggle for our nation's independence, *and be it further*

***Resolved:*** That the Secretary of State be directed to send a copy of this resolution to Senator Mark Daly, Chairperson of the Senate of Ireland, and to the leadership of the American Irish State Legislators Caucus.